

Nanxi Li

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EDUCATION

Shanghai Jiao Tong University

Bachelor of Computer Science, Zhiyuan College (Honors Program)

Shanghai, China

Expected June 2027

- GPA: 90.8/100, 3.93/4.3
- English Proficiency: TOEFL 112, CET-4 (635), CET-6 (613)

EXPERIENCE

Research Intern

SaFoLab, advised by Chaowei Xiao

March 2025 – Present

Johns Hopkins University

Research on safety alignment, guardrails, auditing, and self-evolving agents.

Research Intern

XuanWu Lab, mentored by Jiashuo Liang and Guancheng Li

June 2025 – October 2025

Tencent, Beijing

Research on universal adversarial attacks against VLM-based GUI agents.

Research Intern

RHOS-MVIG Lab, advised by Yong-Lu Li

June 2024 – March 2025

Shanghai Jiao Tong University

Research on benchmarking multimodal LLM capabilities, including associative reasoning and intuitive physics.

PUBLICATIONS

Beyond Static Vision: Scene Dynamic Field Unlocks Intuitive Physics Understanding in MLLMs

Nanxi Li, Xiang Wang, Yuanjie Chen, Haode Zhang, Hong Li, Yong-Lu Li

ICLR 2026

arXiv:2604.03302

The Labyrinth of Links: Navigating the Associative Maze of Multi-modal LLMs

Hong Li, Nanxi Li, Yuanjie Chen, Jianbin Zhu, Qinlu Guo, Cewu Lu, Yong-Lu Li

ICLR 2025

arXiv:2410.01417

Heuristic Reminders: Guiding Vision-Language Models Towards Safe and Faithful Reasoning

Nanxi Li, Chaowei Xiao

SeT-LLM Workshop @ KDD 2026

OpenReview

PRISM: Robust VLM Alignment with Principled Reasoning for Integrated Safety in Multimodality

Nanxi Li, Zhengyue Zhao, G. Edward Suh, Marco Pavone, Chaowei Xiao

In submission

arXiv:2508.18649

LPG: Balancing Efficiency and Policy Reasoning in Latent Policy Guardrails

Nanxi Li, Zhengyue Zhao, Chaowei Xiao

In submission

arXiv:2605.17329

EvoSafeHarness: Evolving Model- and Domain-Specific Harnesses for Securing Agents

Nanxi Li, Yingzi Ma, Yulong Cao, Edward Suh, Bo Li, Dawn Song, Chaowei Xiao

In submission

arXiv:2609.05903

AWARDS

ACM ICPC Regional, Gold Medal $\times$ 3 Hefei, Jinan, and Shenzhen sites

2023

National Olympiad in Informatics (NOI), Silver Medal

2022

Irving T. Ho Fellowship Only recipient in class

2025

SJTU Class A Scholarship Only recipient in class

2024

Zhiyuan Honorary Scholarship Top 5% in SJTU

2023, 2024, 2025

SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

Universal Adversarial Attacks on GUI Agents (Unpublished intern work)

June 2025 – Oct 2025

Studied universal adversarial patches that hijack VLM-based GUI agents into harmful multi-step actions.

DynAuditClaw: Dynamic Security Audit for OpenClaw Agents (Open-sourced)

March 2026 – April 2026

Open-sourced an autonomous-agent framework for targeted attacks, secure Docker testing, and audit reports.